INDIANA STATE POLICE	***STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE*** State Form 39870(R/S-06)	Reference Number EWS-001
	Subject Wellness Section	
	Special Instructions New SOP	Effective Date **December 10, 2025**

I. PURPOSE

Establishes the Indiana State Police Wellness Section (WS). The Wellness Section provides coordinated wellness services to promote and sustain the psychological, emotional, spiritual, and physical well-being of all ISP employees and their families.

II. POLICY

The WS has the responsibility to manage and coordinate the activation and response of the Peer Support Team, the Chaplain duties and responsibilities, as well as the deployment of the Critical Incident Stress Management Team. The WS shall also work closely with an Anthem Representative to ensure the best opportunities and services will be provided through the Employee Assistance Program.

The WS shall provide support to all sworn officers, professional staff, retirees, and family members of department employees who seek or are referred to the WS for services. All personnel participating in or assigned to the WS must adhere to all WS policies to ensure professionalism, confidentiality, and ethical standards.

III. DEFINITIONS

A. CHAPLAIN PROGRAM* - A faith-based support network, comprised of the department chaplain and a network of volunteer chaplains, that provides spiritual care, crisis intervention, and pastoral services to ISP employees, retirees, and families regardless of faith or belief system.

*NOTE – The Department does not endorse any faith, but allows chaplains from various denominations to volunteer to assist department members. The use of the chaplain service is voluntary and the assignment of a chaplain should not be seen as an endorsement of the chaplain's religion.

B. CONFIDENTIALITY - All communications made in connection with the Peer Support, EAP, Chaplain, or CISM programs are to be treated as confidential, consistent with Indiana law, ISP policy, and ethical standards. Exceptions exist when there is imminent threat to life, safety, or elder, spousal, or child abuse.

C. CRITICAL INCIDENT STRESS MANAGEMENT (CISM) TEAM - A trained, multidisciplinary team within the ISP that provides structured psychological and emotional support following exposure to traumatic or high-stress events. The team employs the International Critical Incident Stress Foundation (ICISF) model to deliver interventions such as defusing, debriefings, and follow-up support designed to reduce post-incident stress and promote recovery.

D. EMPLOYEE ASSISTANCE PROGRAM (EAP) - A confidential professional counseling and referral licensed mental health counseling, crisis response, and specialized treatment resources. It also provides services that facilitate everyday stressors encountered by department employees and families.

E. WELLNESS SECTION (WS) - A coordinated section within the Indiana State Police responsible for overseeing all wellness-related programs, providing both proactive and reactive support for employee well-being, and maintaining confidentiality and ethical standards.

F. PEER SUPPORT TEAM - A structured, confidential program where trained ISP personnel provide peer-level emotional and psychological support to coworkers coping with personal or professional challenges. It serves as an early intervention and bridge to professional resources.

IV. PROCEDURE

A. The WS shall report to the Deputy Superintendent of Support Services Bureau.

1. A trooper, rank to be determined by the Superintendent, shall be appointed to serve as WS Commander.

2. An employee shall be appointed to serve as WS Coordinator. If the employee is a sworn officer, the rank for the position shall be set by the Superintendent. The WS Coordinator shall report to the WS Commander.

B. Responsibilities:

1. The WS Commander shall be responsible for:

a. Supervision* of the CISM Regional Coordinators;
b. Supervision* of the Area Peer Support Managers;
c. Supervision* of Peer Support Team Members;
d. Supervision of the Department Chaplain;
e. Oversight of the volunteer chaplain program and volunteers;
f. Coordinating with the Department insurance provider to offer employee resources, such as the EAP;
g. Other duties as assigned.

*NOTE – Supervision of these positions will be only as serving in identified wellness role, i.e. CISM Coordinator, etc. Daily supervision for job responsibilities shall remain with the assigned supervisor for the applicable employee.

2. The WS Coordinator shall be responsible for:

a. Assisting the WS Commander;
b. Monitoring day-to-day operations of the wellness program;
c. Assigning peer support team members to individuals identified as in need of wellness services;

d. Maintaining records, statistical data, and overall usage of the Wellness Program;
e. Other duties as assigned.

C. This procedure is to be used in conjunction with all relevant Department regulations, policies and procedures.